Pearlbound

1. Idea

Pearlbound is a game about a diver who collects pearls and avoids underwater mines. The goal is to survive for 60 seconds until the rescue beacon turns on.

2. Genre and platform

A single-player survival platformer for Android. The screen is horizontal. A round lasts about one minute.

3. 2D or 3D

The game is 2D, with a side view and pixel-art sprites. The diver moves along the seabed and jumps from the ground or a ledge.

4. Gameplay

Move, avoid mines, collect pearls and survive. The player starts with three hearts. Mines deal damage, and healing bubbles restore health. After taking damage, the player is protected for two seconds. Losing all hearts restarts the round.

5. Controls

Left and Right move the diver. Kick jumps from a surface. Hold Bubble to shoot bubbles; they do not deal damage yet. Pause stops the game. Resume continues, Restart starts a new round, and Menu returns to the menu. Play starts the game and Quit closes it.

6. Content

One level, one diver, two ledges, three pearls and one rescue arch. Small mines deal one damage, large mines deal two, and healing bubbles restore one heart. One patrolling fish is planned for a later assignment.

7. Art and sound

The diver, mines, ruins and bubbles are from Underwater Diving Pack by ansimuz. The pearl is from 16x16 Pearl by MallardTV. Both are free CC0 assets from OpenGameArt.org. Sounds are from Kenney Digital Audio, also CC0. The game uses blue and green underwater art. Licenses are saved in the project.

8. MVP

By week 15, the game should have one playable level, a menu, a HUD, a pause screen and mobile buttons. It should also have the fish enemy, a saved best score, sound settings and simple effects.

9. Cut list

No multiplayer, shop, accounts, online leaderboard, extra worlds or randomly generated levels. No free swimming in every direction.

10. Plan and roles

Week 9: GDD, repository, mobile UI and device layouts.
Week 10: add the fish enemy and balance the mines.
Week 11: save the best score and sound setting.
Week 12: improve sounds and effects.
Week 13: test on Android and fix bugs.
This is a solo project until week 14. The work includes design, programming, choosing assets, testing and presenting the game.